

Noble

From CEG

Latinos Refuse Recruiting Role

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Boricuas Unidos, a Puerto Rican student group at Yale, has charged the University with failure to commit itself in a meaningful way to the recruitment of Puerto Rican applicants.

In a public letter to Yale President Kingman Brewster, Jr., Boricuas Unidos announced its withdrawal from the Yale Minority Recruitment Committee until the University demonstrates a sincere willingness to actively recruit Puerto Ricans.

Matters came to a head for the Puerto Rican group when they found that "the so-called expanded recruitment effort is tailored to the needs of the Admissions Office without regard to the needs of the mainland Puerto Rican student."

Boricuas Unidos stated in its letter "the piecemeal recruitment effort envisioned by Yale College for next year is presently doomed to failure." (For the full text of the letter see page 2).

Henry Chauncey, Jr., secretary to the university, declined to comment on the complaints of Boricuas Unidos since its letter was not yet available to him.

Indicative of Yale's insensitivity to the needs of Puerto Rican students, according to Boricuas Unidos, was the failure of the administration to respond officially to a memorandum on the admission of Puerto Ricans which the group submitted in September to Charles Taylor, Yale provost, Chauncey, and John Muyskens, Jr., dean of undergraduate admissions.

12 Puerto Ricans At Yale

The report stated that while 1.4 million Puerto Ricans live within a 70 mile radius of Yale, only 12 are at present enrolled at Yale as undergraduates, and 17 in the University as a whole.

While Chicanos and Puerto Ricans are represented in comparable numbers in the U.S. population, there are some 65 undergraduate Chicanos at Yale.

Thus, says Boricuas Unidos, though "Yale has been successful in recruiting Black Americans and Mexican-Americans in the recent past, they have failed to do so for the mainland Puerto Rican."

The letter from the Puerto

Rican group goes further to point out what Boricuas Unidos feels are a series of rigid constraints set by the Admissions Office for recruitment procedure.

In addition, states the letter, some Puerto Rican applicants have been discouraged from applying on the basis of SAT and achievement scores.

Boricuas Unidos also notes there is no Puerto Rican representation on the Admissions Committee or among staffers who interview candidates for admission.

Testifying that Princeton has some 20 Puerto Rican undergraduates and Columbia has enrolled 46, Boricuas Unidos recommends that Yale commit itself to increased admissions of Puerto Ricans with the object of a Puerto Rican representation in the student body commensurate with that group's national representation.

Supervisory Committee

Yale created a Supervisory Committee this year made up of representatives from the four minority groups at Yale and certain university officials whose purpose is the development of an ongoing, comprehensive recruitment program. Apparently Boricuas Unidos does not believe the work of such a committee will have fruitful results.

There also exist four new bursary jobs at the Admissions Office, one for a member of each minority group, including the Puerto Rican.

Each student is responsible for the coordination of recruitment activities for his or her minority.

Despite these changes, students like Alberto Alvarado, 1973, a Chicano recruiter, assert "no great strides have been taken to help us in recruiting and assuring the matriculation of larger numbers of Latinos."

At Wesleyan, where 17 Puerto Ricans are enrolled in the freshman class of 440, one assistant dean of admissions focuses on minority recruitment alone.

"We develop a pool of Latin students and take the best applicants in the pool," said Randy Miller. "These students are competing against other Latino candidates, not against the larger applicant pool."

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